



FLINTLOCK PISTOLS (1650–1700)

In the second half of the 17th century, flintlock firearms in Europe were developed into the form they were to keep until well into the 19th century. Various flintlock mechanisms had been in use by the middle of the 17th century, but by 1700 the “French” design of lock had become the most common throughout Europe. Seen predominantly in the “sear” or cock-release mechanism underneath the lock plate of the gun, French influence was also considerable on the form and decoration of pistols and other firearms. However, regional styles, such as those in Austria and Silesia (in modern-day Poland, Germany, and the Czech Republic), continued to prosper.



▲ AUSTRIAN HOLSTER PISTOL

Date	c.1690
Origin	Austria
Barrel	14in (35.5cm)
Caliber	.64in (16.2mm)

Holster pistols were heavy, with long barrels and metal butt caps. Made in Vienna by Lamarre, this ornate example, although certainly atypical in the extent and high quality of its decoration, represents the state of the gunmaker’s art as it was in the last decades of the 17th century.



Staghorn inlay

Trigger

Jaw

Frizzen

Pan

Twin cocks



FULL VIEW

▲ SILESIAN HOLSTER PISTOL

Date	c.1680
Origin	Silesia
Barrel	14in (35.5cm)
Caliber	.54in (13.7mm)

This large, sophisticated holster pistol was made in the principality of Teschen (now divided between the Czech Republic and Poland), but shows considerable German influence in the angular shape and beveled edges of its lock. The staghorn inlaid decoration of the stock is also of German origin and indicates that the gun was made as a presentation piece.

Metal-bound butt

Figured walnut stock

Lock plate

Trigger for upper barrel

Trigger for lower barrel

Butt is brass-bound